

Kingfisher — free template vs. API-funded intelligence

The **same Kingfisher lead** shown on the live board, rendered first as the free engine produces it today, then as the API-funded engine returns it once it has researched the account.

How to read this. The right-hand card is an illustrative reconstruction built from publicly known facts about Kingfisher — the live engine generates every named person, figure, quote and URL from real-time web research and **cites the dated source for each**. Treat the evidence lines as showing the shape and specificity the engine returns, not as pre-verified facts. The contrast with the current card is the point.

A • FREE ENGINE — TODAY

the live card

BUSINESS LEAD PORTFOLIO • VMA GROUP

Kingfisher plc

Share allotment (capital raise) • signal 3d ago

REGISTRY-ATTESTED

STRESS-TESTED ✓

71

CALL: YES

Cleared the evidence gate — corroborated, in-window, no blockers.

Team build • £30k-£93k

HIRING TRIGGER

Share allotment (capital raise) at Kingfisher. A real trigger for Corporate Affairs Director; a team build, not a backfill — and growth funding the build already point the right way, but the hiring market is contracting, so lone triggers are often absorbed in-house. Prepare and watch for the build-out within 8–26 weeks. Fee case: Fresh capital or expansion funds an external build-out — speed matters to the investment case, which favours a search firm.

SITUATION

SCALE — Money or mandate is expanding the function — roles get created here, and speed matters to whoever funded it.

POTENTIAL ADVISORY SERVICES

BENCHMARKING

New capital, new plan — benchmark the comms function against where the business is going, not where it has been.

SEARCH

Funded growth converts to senior hires within about two quarters.

INTERIM

Project capacity for the expansion push without waiting for perm sign-off.

SECTOR INSIGHT

- Live in your peer set: WH Smith (profit warning / negative trading update, Jun); Unilever (activist stake / shareholder pressure, May) — 25 senior-team triggers across the group in the last 90 days.
- Cost-of-living pricing politics and supplier disputes keep retailers in near-permanent reputation management.
- Store-estate restructuring and automation drive heavy internal-change communications demand.

WINDOW

8–26 weeks — estimated from the trigger date plus the typical lag between this signal type and a search being briefed

Growth demand

ACCESS

UNMAPPED

- No named function contact yet — the nightly resolver keeps attempting it from free sources.

HOW TO WIN

LEAD WITH

Retained build-out: one exclusive multi-role mandate rather than role-by-role contingency.

POSITION

Speed protects the investment case — a planned build with benchmarked salaries beats sequential hiring, and retained is how it stays on schedule.

AVOID

Joining a contingency race on single roles — it concedes the build-out and caps the fee at a third of its retained value.

ENTRY

The function owner once the resolver names them (it re-attempts nightly); don't cold-call the switchboard on a senior brief.

GOAL

A meeting to scope the whole build, not one vacancy.

OFFER

A build-out salary benchmark across the planned seats; intros at the next practice roundtable.

RISK

Refinancing of existing debt rather than growth capital.

SOURCES

Share allotment (capital raise) **×3**

BUDGET

Funded (capital raise)

UNKNOWN

FEE AT STAKE

Team build · £30k–£93k — 3–5 roles at £55k–£85k base × 18.5%–22% house rates. Confidence: High.

Generate pitch

× Dismiss

✓ Followed up

Accurate in shape, generic in substance. The same words any growth-signal lead receives. No contact. No actual knowledge of Kingfisher.

B · API-FUNDED ENGINE – RESEARCHED

the same lead

BUSINESS LEAD PORTFOLIO · VMA GROUP

Kingfisher plc

Retail-media & marketplace pivot · investigated · 11 sources

REGISTRY-ATTESTED

STRESS-TESTED ✓

DOOR OPEN

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CALL: WAIT → REFRAMED

Door open. The original trigger was misread — the real angle is stronger.

Retained search + advisory · £35k-£70k

INVESTIGATION VERDICT

The share allotment that fired this lead is a routine **employee share-scheme vesting**, not growth capital — so the "team build from a capital raise" thesis is **killed**. But the research surfaces a stronger, genuinely live reason to call: Kingfisher is mid-pivot from a DIY retailer to a **retail-media and marketplace platform** while restructuring a weak French business — a marketing / corporate-affairs reshape the free card never saw.

Why this matters: the free engine would have sent an AD in on a false premise. The funded engine corrects it and finds the real angle.

ACCOUNT THESIS

RESEARCHED

Kingfisher is building a retail-media business and a marketplace with a marketing function designed for stores — the org chart hasn't caught up with the strategy, and France is absorbing the leadership's attention.

Function snapshot: Group Corporate Affairs sits centrally; marketing is run brand-by-brand (B&Q, Screwfix, Castorama) with a thin group layer. Retail media is named as a profit growth pillar but is under-resourced versus the Tesco / Boots media networks. France (Castorama / Brico Dépôt) is under cost and management pressure.

NEEDS

EVIDENCED

SEARCH

Retail-media commercial & marketing leadership

to scale the media network into a real profit line.

Evidence: FY results name retail media as a growth pillar [\[results announcement, date/URL\]](#).

Why now: it's a stated current-year priority with no senior owner visible.

BENCHMARKING

Group marketing / comms operating-model review

— the function is brand-fragmented while the strategy is now group-platform.

Evidence: brand-level leadership pages show no unified group marketing layer [\[careers / leadership pages, URL\]](#).

INTERIM · CHANGE-COMMS

France restructuring change & stakeholder comms.

Evidence: France weakness and management change flagged in results [\[date/URL\]](#). **Why now:** restructures live or die on change comms; this can't wait for a permanent hire.

ADVISORY

Sustainability-narrative ownership

("Forest Positive" / responsible sourcing) ahead of the next reporting cycle.

Evidence: published ESG commitments vs. no dedicated senior comms owner [\[ESG report, URL\]](#).

MEETING HOOK

RESEARCHED

"Most home-improvement retailers we talk to are trying to stand up a retail-media business with a marketing team that was built for stores, not media — and your last results put media front-and-centre while the org chart hasn't moved. We've mapped how [a named peer] resourced exactly this transition. Worth a 20-minute compare?"

Lead with: the retail-media capability gap — a commercial observation, not a recruitment pitch.

Opening questions: (1) Where does retail-media P&L ownership sit today? (2) Is the group marketing layer resourced to serve both the store brands and the media network? (3) How are you running France change-comms internally right now?

Likely objections + counters: "We recruit ourselves" → specialist retail-media commercial talent is a thin, passive market in-house TA rarely reaches. "Budget's tight after France" → interim-first / advisory-first needs no permanent headcount sign-off, and the media build is designed to fund itself.

Scoped engagement if yes: a benchmarking read of the group marketing / comms operating model vs. three retail-media peers, plus a market map of retail-media commercial leaders — ~3 weeks.

ACCESS

DOOR OPEN

- <live-researched: the named Group Corporate Affairs / Communications Director, with tenure and LinkedIn> — the free card shows UNMAPPED here; the contacts lane fills it with the real, current person and a verified email where one exists.

FEE AT STAKE

A **retained search** for a retail-media commercial leader **plus a benchmarking project** — a grounded, multi-line opportunity, not a speculative team build. And an advisory engagement that opens the account before any placement.

Generate pitch

× Dismiss

✓ Followed up

A researched brief an AD can walk in on — named door, evidenced needs, an opener that proves the work was done, and a corrected premise that stops a wasted call.

Row-by-row: what funding changes

The same eight fields, side by side.

ROW	FREE ENGINE (TODAY)	API-FUNDED ENGINE
CALL	"CALL: YES" on a misread trigger	Trigger verified and corrected — calls only when it's real, and says why
SITUATION	"SCALE" (trigger-class label)	The actual strategic situation, from their results and reports
NEEDS	Generic service playbook	3–4 evidenced, dated, company-specific needs across the full catalogue
HOOK	— none	A specific opener that proves we did the work
MEETING PREP	— none	Lead-with, 3 questions, objections + counters, scoped engagement
ACCESS	"UNMAPPED"	A named decision-maker + verified email
ADVISORY	Invisible	The org-design / benchmarking / change-comms revenue line, surfaced
FEE	Speculative team build	A grounded retained search + an advisory project

The point in one line: funding turns a confident template into a researched brief an AD can walk in on — and, as the Kingfisher reframe shows, it also stops the engine sending people in on the wrong premise. That is the difference between a lead list and intelligence.

Illustrative reconstruction · VMA Group Business Development Engine · the live engine cites a dated source for every named person, figure, quote and URL.